

JINYUQI (MONICA) HUANG

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Department of Economics, HKUST, Clear Water Bay, Kowloon, Hong Kong SAR

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EDUCATION

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Sep 2021 – Present

M.Phil. and Ph.D. in Economics, GPA: 3.94/4.3

The Chinese University of Hong Kong (Shenzhen)

Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

M.Sc. in Economics, GPA: 3.93/4.0

Renmin University of China

Sep 2015 – Jun 2019

B.A. in Economics, GPA: 3.64/4.0

Purdue University

Jan – Jun 2026

Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics (hosted by Timothy Cason and Matthew Kovach)

California Institute of Technology

Feb – Mar 2026

Visiting Scholar, Division of the Humanities and Social Sciences (hosted by Marina Agranov)

RESEARCH FIELDS

Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics, Game Theory

WORKING PAPERS

1. **“Role Uncertainty and Punishment Severity in Repeated Cheap Talk: Theory and Experiment”** (Job Market Paper) with Wooyoung Lim

- **Revise and Resubmit** at *Games and Economic Behavior*.

- Abstract: We investigate the efficacy of the shadow of the future in sustaining information transmission under partially aligned interests by manipulating two institutional features: punishment severity and role uncertainty. While theory suggests that these features potentially facilitate fully revealing equilibria relative to a baseline of fixed roles and mild punishment, our experiment documents an asymmetric effect on sender and receiver behavior. Harsh punishment with fixed roles disciplines senders but fails to elicit trust from receivers. Conversely, mild punishment with role uncertainty fosters trust rather than honesty, supporting an outcome where senders obtain their preferred action without needing to be truthful. The combination of both features asymmetrically improves subjects’ honesty as senders but discourages their trust as receivers. Our findings imply that mechanisms aiming for truthful and efficient communication must carefully tailor incentives for both roles, rather than relying solely on disciplining the informed sender.

- Funded by an RPG student research grant from the Department of Economics at HKUST.

- Presentations:

2026: Midwest Economic Theory Conference (OSU); Ostrom-Smith Conference on Experimental and Behavioral Economics (Purdue); HKUST PhD Student Conference; HKEA (Macau U); AMES-China (HKU); ESEM (Dublin, scheduled).

2025: ESA Asia-Pacific Conference (Osaka U); 3rd Science of Decision Making Conference (SWUFE).

2024: ESA Asia-Pacific Conference (NTU); 7th World Congress of the Game Theory Society (PKU).

2. **“First They Came for the Others: A Theory of Divide-and-Conquer”** with Yeon-Koo Che and Wooyoung Lim

- Abstract: Divide-and-conquer tactics often succeed not through mechanical coordination failures, but through epistemic friction regarding an aggressor’s underlying intent. When an attacker strikes a first target, bystanders must infer whether the assault represents a localized grievance or a systemic campaign. If the attack is rationally interpreted as particularized, bystanders abstain, prompting the isolated victim to surrender. We demonstrate how higher attack costs and lower correlation between victims’ fates facilitate this division. We then study how behavioral responses, rhetoric, treaty commitments, and downstream defense networks modify this inference.
- Presentations (internal seminars): Caltech; Purdue.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. “First They Came for the Others: An Experiment of Divide-and-Conquer” with Yeon-Koo Che and Wooyoung Lim
 - This is an experimental project related to our theory paper.
2. “Correlation Sensitivity in Social Context: Theory and Experiment” with Hendrik Rommeswinkel
 - We characterize a model of “fear of missing out” (FOMO) that nests both individual regret aversion and social regret aversion, and we apply the model to the SMLoA tasks and propose experimental tests.
3. “Incentivizing Teamwork: An Experiment” with Timothy Cason and Heng Liu
 - This is an experimental investigation into how the observability of peer effort and bonus contracts impacts the cost-effectiveness of incentivizing teamwork.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

- Applied Econometrics (MSc), Prof. Junlong Feng 2022, 2023, 2025
- Econometrics (PhD), Prof. Peng Wang 2023, 2024, 2025
- Empirical Methods for Economics Analysis (DBA), Prof. Peng Wang 2023, 2024, 2025
- Microeconomic Analysis (MSc), Prof. Yuk Fai Fong 2024

Teaching Assistant, The Chinese University of Hong Kong (Shenzhen)

- Advanced Econometrics II (PhD), Prof. Liyu Dou 2021
- Introductory Econometrics (UG), Prof. Qihui Chen 2020

Teaching Assistant, Renmin University of China

- Macroeconomics (UG), Prof. Zhanming Chen 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, School of Business and Management, HKUST Jun 2024 – Jun 2025

- UG data analysis for Prof. Melody Chao (Associate Director of UG Programs) and Prof. Allen Huang (Associate Dean of UG Programs).

Binary Quantile Selection Model (M.Phil Thesis), SBM, HKUST Jun 2022 – Jun 2023

- Advised by Prof. Songnian Chen and Prof. Junlong Feng.
- Presented at the 2023 Shanghai Advanced Workshop of Econometrics (SUFE).
- Abstract: This paper is the first to study the identification and estimation of a linear quantile regression model subject to endogenous sample selection with binary outcome variables. We model the endogenous

sample selection by a copula function with a low-dimensional unknown parameter vector, characterize the semi-parametric identification conditions, and propose an easy-to-implement three-step estimation method. The key steps include estimating the copula parameters by a non-linear least squares estimation (NLLS) with local smoothing given estimators of quantile parameters at the post-selection quantile levels, and then estimating the quantile parameters at the pre-selection quantile levels by a smoothed maximum score estimation (SMS) given the estimated copula parameters. We also show that the estimator is consistent and asymptotically normal. A simple Monte Carlo simulation illustrates that our estimator has reasonably good finite sample properties.

Research Assistant, School of Management and Economics, CUHK (SZ) May 2020 – Aug 2020

- Machine learning and density forecasting for Prof. Liyu Dou.

Research Assistant, School of Economics, Renmin University of China Feb 2018 – Jun 2019

- RA for Prof. Zhanming Chen and Prof. Xiaohua Xia
- Xia, X. and Huang, J., “Industrial Division and Ecological Factor Accounting Under Global Value Chain: A Literature Review”, *Journal of China University of Petroleum (Social Science)*, 2019, 35(2): 1–16.
- Huang, J., Xia, X., and Chen, Z., “Impacts of global value chain on spatial transfer of ecological elements: A case study of virtual water use for iPhone6”, *Acta Ecologica Sinica* (collected by Chinese Science Citation Database), 2020, 40(7): 2473–2488.

HONORS AND AWARDS

RedBird Academic Excellence Award	HKUST	2026
University Global Research Award	HKUST	2025
University Research Travel Grant (×2)	HKUST	2025-2026
Departmental Research Travel Grant (×2)	HKUST	2023-2024
Departmental Research Grant	HKUST	2023
RedBird PhD Award	HKUST	2023
Research Postgraduate Scholarship	HKUST	2021–Present
Presidential Award of Outstanding Graduate Student	CUHK (SZ)	2021
First-class Academic Excellence	CUHK (SZ)	2021
Dean’s List	CUHK (SZ)	2021
Second-class Subject Prize (No.2): Advanced Microeconomics	CUHK (SZ)	2021
First-class Subject Prize (No.1): Advanced Macroeconomics, International Finance, Advanced Monetary Economics	CUHK (SZ)	2019–2020
Gold Entrance Scholarship	CUHK (SZ)	2019
Outstanding Graduate Student (SoE)	Renmin University of China	2019
Second-class Scholarship	Renmin University of China	2018
Third-class Scholarship	Renmin University of China	2016

PROGRAMMING AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

- **Programming:** R, Stata, oTree (Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript), MATLAB, L^AT_EX
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Wooyoung Lim (Ph.D. Supervisor)

Department Head, Professor, Lee Heng Fellow

Department of Economics

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Email: wooyoung@ust.hk

Rui Tang

Associate Professor, Lee Heng Fellow

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Yeon-Koo Che

Kelvin J. Lancaster Professor of Economic Theory

Department of Economics

Columbia University

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Songfa Zhong

Chair Professor

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